

Algebra with functions

In this final review session, we cover the algebra of functions: how to compute the composition, subtraction, addition, and the inverse of functions⁶.

1. Addition and Subtraction of Functions

For two functions f and g , with domains D_f and D_g :

$$(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x), \quad (f - g)(x) = f(x) - g(x)$$

Domain: The domain of $f + g$ or $f - g$ is $D_f \cap D_g$.

2. Composition of Functions

The composition $f \circ g$ is defined by:

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$$

Procedure:

1. Compute $g(x)$.
2. Apply f to the result.

Domain: The domain of $f \circ g$ consists of all x in D_g such that $g(x)$ is in D_f .

3. Inverse Functions

A function f has an inverse f^{-1} if it is **one-to-one** (passes the horizontal line test).

Finding f^{-1} :

1. Write $y = f(x)$.
2. Interchange x and y .
3. Solve for y .
4. Write $f^{-1}(x) = y$.

Properties:

$$f(f^{-1}(x)) = x \quad \text{and} \quad f^{-1}(f(x)) = x$$

Domain and Range: The domain of f^{-1} is the range of f , and the range of f^{-1} is the domain of f .

⁶ January 20

Class Activity

Compute the following operations with functions considering that $f(x) = e^x$, $g(x) = -(x-1)^2 + 1$

$$h(x) = (f \circ g)(x)$$

$$j(x) = (g \circ f)(x)$$

Compute: $h^{-1}(x)$

Compute: $\frac{(g \circ j)(x)}{2}$

Solutions of previous class activity:

$$f(x) = \frac{3x^2 - 1}{x^2 - 1}.$$

Asymptotes: $y = 3$; $x = \pm 1$

Domain: $x \in (-\infty, -1) \cup (-1, 1) \cup (1, \infty)$

Range: $f(x) \in (-\infty, 3) \cup (3, \infty)$

y inteceptions: $f(0) = 1$

x inteceptions: $x = \pm \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$

$$g(x) = \log [2e^{x-4} - 2].$$

Asymptotes: $x = 4$

Domain: $x \in (4, \infty)$

Range: $f(x) \in (-\infty, \infty)$

y inteceptions: No exist

x inteceptions: $x = \ln \left[\frac{3}{2} + 4 \right]$

$$h(x) = e^{(x^2-2)/x}.$$

Asymptotes: $y = 0$

Domain: $x \in (-\infty, \infty)$

Range: $f(x) \in (0, \infty)$

y inteceptions: No exist

x inteceptions: No exist